

Notice of New Jetro Regional and Analysis Reports (August 20, 2026 Issue)

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We are pleased to provide you with information on newly released regional and analysis reports that offer Jetro's unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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****[Special Feature] Current State and New Challenges in Korean Companies' Overseas Expansion <Additional Articles> ****

Due to US-China tensions, rising production costs and oversupply in China, and improved competitiveness of Chinese enterprises, Korean direct investment in China has declined sharply, and Korean businesses in China face increasingly difficult conditions. Meanwhile, direct investment in the US has surged due to US industrial policy, but the outlook remains uncertain with the start of the second Trump administration. Korean companies also show strong interest in Vietnam, the leading "China-Plus-One" destination, and direct investment in Indonesia, Southeast Asia's largest economy, is increasing. Furthermore, major Korean companies are actively expanding operations in India, a large nation expected to achieve high economic growth. This special feature clarifies the current state of Korean companies' overseas expansion.

<Additional Articles>

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (1) Legal Framework Advances for Implementation of US Investment

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (2) Secondary Batteries and Holding Companies Lead US Investment

◇Korean Companies' US Investment (3) Hyundai Motor Group Expands US Investment

****[Asia/China] Game Consoles Drive Shandong Province's Exports to Japan; Food and Apparel Stable, Minerals and Electrical Equipment Declining****

Shandong Province is one of China's regions with the highest dependency on exports to Japan. In 2025, exports to Japan totaled \$20.2 billion, with Japan accounting for 6.7% of exports to the world—the highest concentration ratio nationally (mainland China). The province's 2025 trade surplus with Japan was \$15.6 billion, with both scale and concentration ratio highlighting the strength of Japan relations. Export volume ranks third nationally after Guangdong and Jiangsu provinces, exceeding Shanghai and Zhejiang. While Guangdong and Jiangsu focus on general-purpose electrical and electronic products,

Shandong is characterized by specialization in specific-use items such as food, game consoles, and apparel. This report analyzes export structure to Japan from 2021 to 2025 based on three trends: stable supply of food and apparel, expansion of game consoles, and contraction in other sectors.

****[Africa/Angola] Structural Changes in Angola's Economy; Africa's Major Resource Nation Seeks to Move Beyond Oil Dependence****

Angola has long been described as an "oil-producing nation." It boasts the second-largest crude oil production in Sub-Saharan Africa and achieved high growth backed by oil export revenues from the 2000s through the early 2010s. However, unable to escape a structure dependent on oil revenues for most economic activity, fiscal affairs, and foreign exchange, Angola experienced severe economic stagnation following the crude oil price decline after 2014. Against this backdrop, the João Lourenço administration, which took office in 2017, has prioritized economic diversification and is advancing development of mining, agriculture, manufacturing, and logistics. In recent years, critical mineral development and Lobito Corridor improvements have attracted international attention, and Angola's economy has reached a new turning point. As Japanese corporate presence in this market remains limited, these changes are insufficiently recognized; however, Angola is undergoing dynamic transformation as it shifts from an "oil-producing nation" to a "regional economic hub."

****[Africa/Angola, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Zambia] Lobito Corridor Reshaping Southern Africa's Economic Map; From Critical Mineral Transport to Broad Economic Corridor****

Recent interest has grown in the "Lobito Corridor" connecting Angola's Lobito Port with the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) and Zambia. This corridor is a logistics network originating from Lobito Port on Angola's west coast, utilizing the Benguela Railway to connect to inland mining areas. It has gained attention as a transport route for critical minerals such as copper and cobalt, with support expressed by the US, European Union (EU), African Development Bank (AfDB), and African Finance Corporation (AFC). It is positioned as one of the priority projects under the G7's "Global Infrastructure Investment Partnership (PGII)" and has attracted international attention. However, the Lobito Corridor's significance extends beyond mineral transport. The Angolan government and international development agencies position the corridor as an "economic corridor" promoting regional industrial development and trade expansion, in addition to logistics infrastructure improvements. This report outlines the Lobito Corridor's overview and development history, while examining its economic significance and challenges.

****[Japan] Expanding Konnyaku Exports and Applications Through Foodtech****

In recent years, foodtech has attracted attention as a means of responding to diverse food needs and addressing social challenges against backgrounds of population growth, reduced environmental burden, and rising health consciousness. Konnyaku, a traditional

Japanese food, is not only a healthy food low in calories and rich in dietary fiber, but also utilized as a food ingredient for plant-based foods due to its ease of processing. This report examines new initiatives by companies leveraging konnyaku's characteristics and considers possibilities for future overseas expansion and new demand creation.